1. Introduction

This toolkit is designed to contain a resource about spiking for university staff and students. It explains the symptoms of spiking, where to find support services, and how to report incidents. The aim is to help everyone better understand what spiking is and to support those who may have been spiked to make informed decisions about what to do next.

Existing resources on spiking, from organisations like Spike Aware UK[1], Stamp Out Spiking[2], Life Stuff and the Talk About Trust[3], Drinkaware[4], and the Egalitarian[5] mainly focus on how to recognise the symptoms, reduce risks, stay safe, and report incidents. Our toolkit expands by incorporating guidance from Universities UK[6]. It provides more detailed information on the reporting process, what steps are involved, and the differences between anonymous and non-anonymous reporting. This information is sourced from Police UK[7,8], NHS[9,10], and the Home Office[11,12] websites.

We incorporated the feedback received to produce the final toolkit. Input was gathered from Anglia Ruskin University (ARU) students through focus groups, from staff via internal conferences, and from stakeholders through individual emails and a dedicated event hosted at ARU. This toolkit is designed primarily for use by university staff and students at ARU. However, it is adaptable for use by other universities and sectors through the customisation of institution-specific reporting and support processes.

Spiking is a crime. You have the right not to be spiked:

- You have the right to decide what you eat and drink and what goes into your body.
- You should not have to change your behaviour to avoid being spiked.
- You should not have to avoid bars or clubs or cover your drink at all times[11].